

# Declarer Sheet — Suit

Bridge Habit Map

## AUCTION

---

### Habits

- ☐ Check vulnerability - use to determine aggression level in competitive auction
- ☐ Always bid to show new info - stop when no new info to show
- ☐ Use every bid to get positive and negative info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Use opps' conventional bids to show their HCP / shape
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner - HCP and shape
- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction

### Strategy

- ☐ If it's our hand → bid our contract, or Dbl
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids
- ☐ We have a fit AND opps have a fit + you have length or shortage in theirs → need fewer points for game (~20) in our suit
- ☐ After you T/O and opps make a game try — don't push the bidding
- ☐ When opps bid strangely, be careful

### Bids to remember

- ☐ You can reopen with a Dbl
- ☐ Bid of a minor after 4th-hand protection shows a weak 2 in that minor
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: NT from responder tends to show a max hand
- ☐ After our T/O Dbl: a new suit or NT is strong
- ☐ After our Neg Dbl: a new suit is a weak 6-card suit
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → partner's Dbl is for penalties
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → Pass is a forcing pass (partner must Dbl or bid the suit again)
- ☐ Opps sacrifice → bidding the suit again shows the strongest hand

## PLAN — DISCIPLINE & LEAD

---

### Discipline

- ☐ Count our winners and losers
- ☐ Use info from opps' bidding and passing
- ☐ Use info from the opening lead
- ☐ Work out likely suit splits and where opps' high cards sit

### Design the play

- ☐ Tricks to create = contract – winners
- ☐ Tools: ruff in short hand, create shortage for a ruff, cross-ruff, finesse
- ☐ Look for loser-on-loser elimination, squeeze, or throw-in
- ☐ Confirm entries for the planned play
- ☐ Decide when and how to draw trumps

### Playing it out

- ☐ Don't be afraid to draw trumps even on a misfit
- ☐ If cross-ruffing, set up side suits first
- ☐ Play safe / the percentages — allow for 4-1 or 3-0 splits when a finesse is on
- ☐ If drawing trumps, make sure you have no suit losers in the short-trump hand
- ☐ Find losers in the long hand — discard them on dummy's winners
- ☐ In NT, if they lead your hidden 5-card suit, still play the hand properly
- ☐ If the outcome is fixed, try to fool the opps and sneak a trick

## PLAN — SUIT

---

### Count

- ☐ Count losers in each suit
- ☐ Pick a master hand (long-trump hand; stronger in 4-4)
- ☐ Cross-check by counting winners

### Source of extras

- ☐ Can dummy cover losers? (ruffs, side-suit, finesse, throw-in)
- ☐ Consider dummy reversal, cross-ruff, loser-on-loser, endplay

### Trump management

- ☐ Draw trumps now or postpone?
- ☐ If ruffs needed in dummy — set up before drawing